



▲ THE THREE ARCHWAYS OF THE ARCH OF CONSTANTINE

312 and 315 CE, was the last to be erected and is one of only three that survive. At 85 ft (25.9 m) wide and 69 ft (21 m) high, it is the largest of Rome's triumphal arches. It has three archways—the central one larger than the other two—flanked by four projecting columns on raised bases. Carved reliefs, simply lifted from earlier structures, and an

inscription over the central arch, originally in bronze, attest to the emperor's martial valor.

St. George's Church

Location Salonika, Greece

There was always an uncomfortable transition in building types between

those of pagan Rome and those of the Rome decreed Christian by Constantine after 313 CE. It was an awkwardness reinforced by the division of the empire in 395 CE into western and eastern halves, which in the east gave rise to an increasingly distinctive Byzantine architecture. St. George's Church reflects the first phases of this process. It is an extension, completed

in about 395 CE, to an earlier, circular structure. To this was added a portico, a commanding apse, and an even more commanding dome, 80 ft (24.5 m) in diameter. The church has been stripped of almost all of its original decoration, leaving behind its massive, arched masonry, some 20 ft (6 m) thick, and some surviving later Byzantine mosaics.